.things that Matter

Project Charter

Company Name	.things that Matter
Document Type	Project Charter
Version	1.0
Date	January 21, 2026
Author	Matome Mboweni, CTO

1. Company Vision

Vision Statement: Make commerce portable, viral, and universally accessible - for humans today, AI agents tomorrow, and a decentralized economy in the future.

1.1 The Problem

- Products are trapped in platform silos (Shopify, Amazon, WooCommerce)
- Sharing a product = sharing a link to a storefront
- AI agents waste compute scraping HTML to find product data
- Commerce is a destination, not a layer of reality

1.2 The Solution

Object-Oriented Commerce: Products as self-sovereign digital objects (.thing files) that travel freely across the internet, carrying their own identity, price, semantics, and checkout logic.

1.3 Strategic Phases

Phase	Focus	Moat	Timeline
Phase 1	Viral Commerce - Create .thing files	Accessibility	2026
Phase 2	Agentic Commerce - AI efficiency	Energy Efficiency	2027
Phase 3	Decentralized Commerce - Blockchain	Decentralization	2028+

2. Business Objectives

ID	Objective	Success Metric
OBJ-1	Prove steganography viability	≥50% platform survival
OBJ-2	Build Commerce Compiler	Compile 10K products
OBJ-3	Launch Browser Extension	100+ active users
OBJ-4	Onboard Beta Merchants	5-10 merchants

OBJ-5	Validate market demand	User feedback + growth

3. Scope

In Scope (Phase 1):

- .thing file format (FlatBuffers binary)
- Commerce Compiler (Python MVP, Rust production)
- CLIP semantic vectorization
- Ed25519 cryptographic signing
- Steganographic distribution (polyglot images)
- matter:// URI protocol
- Shadow Index API
- Browser extension (Chrome)

Out of Scope (Phase 1):

- Mobile applications
- Blockchain integration
- Multi-currency payments
- Enterprise white-labeling

4. Budget Summary

Category	Annual (ZAR)
Development Tools	R6,048
AI & ML APIs	R21,600
Infrastructure	R7,560
Payments & Financial	R10,800
Domains & Publishing	R500
One-Time Costs	R2,800
Contingency (5%)	R3,600
TOTAL	**R72,000**

5. Timeline

Milestone	Date	Completion
Contract Signed	Jan 21, 2026	0%
Phase 0 Complete	Mar 2, 2026	15%
Foundation Complete	Apr 27, 2026	30%
Core Complete	Jul 20, 2026	50%
Extension Functional	Aug 17, 2026	75%
Beta Launch	Oct 26, 2026	90%
Public Launch	Dec 15, 2026	100%

6. Stakeholders

Role	Name	Responsibility
CEO	Sobuhle Nyambali	Vision, strategy, funding, business development
CTO	Matome Mboweni	Architecture, development, technical decisions

7. Document Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
CEO	Sobuhle Nyambali	_____	___/___/2026
CTO	Matome Mboweni	_____	___/___/2026